

The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

🌀 SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

PUBLIC HEALTH & STATE POWER

Roman civic governance → Medieval municipal neglect → 1848 Public Health Act (L1, L2, L4)

SANITARY ENGINEERING & TECH

Roman aqueducts → Lead piping → Bazalgette's brick sewer network (L1, L6)

ETIOLOGY & SCIENTIFIC EMPIRICISM

Divine retribution & Miasma → John Snow's Broad St map → Germ Theory (L3, L5)

WORKING-CLASS ACTIVISM & RIGHTS

Polluted town riots → Water rate strikes → Public demand for health infrastructure (L2, L4)

Lesson Number & Title

Learning Objectives & Enquiry

Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment

Lesson 1

How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

CHANGE & CONTINUITY

- Describe the simple, practical sanitation methods used by Iron Age Britons.
- Explain how Roman engineers introduced revolutionary sanitation technology.
- Evaluate the significance of Roman bathhouses and latrines for public health.

Hinge Q: How did the Romans manage to keep the water flowing constantly into their forts?

📖 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:

Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics

🗣️ DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:

Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission

📝 CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:

Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages? HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & MONASTIC LIFE	- Describe the simple cesspits used by peasants in rural Medieval villages. - Explain why Medieval monasteries built complex water systems. - Evaluate the role of gongfarmers and night-work in medieval towns. Hinge Q: Why were medieval drinking wells so dangerous?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period? CAUSATION & ETIOLOGICAL BELIEFS	- Describe the sanitation problems in growing Tudor and Stuart towns. - Explain why early flushing toilets like Sir John Harington's failed to catch on. - Evaluate how Samuel Pepys's diary reveals the reality of Early Modern sanitation. Hinge Q: Why did the rivers in early modern towns become open sewers?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into how London authorities and medical practitioners attempted to control the 1665 Great Plague?
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis? HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & STATE INTERVENTION	- Describe the overcrowded and unhygienic conditions of industrial back-to-back housing. - Explain how Edwin Chadwick argued for public health reform in his 1842 report. - Evaluate Dr. John Snow's discovery that cholera was waterborne. Hinge Q: Why did the rapid building of factories lead to a housing crisis?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Evaluative Enquiry] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into why Victorian medical authorities resisted John Snow's discovery that cholera was water-borne?
Lesson 5 Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets? SOURCE UTILITY & EPIDEMIOLOGICAL MAPPING	- Describe the events of the Great Stink in 1858. - Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system transformed London. - Evaluate how Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory revolutionized our understanding of disease. Hinge Q: Why did Parliament suddenly care about public health in 1858?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859-1865); Eastney Beam Engine Pumping Station, Portsmouth: Civic Sanitation Masterpiece (1887) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.
Lesson 6 End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation TURNING POINT ANALYSIS & CIVIL ENGINEERING	- Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. - Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. - Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain the significance of John Snow's discovery during the 1854 Broad Street Cholera outbreak. (8 marks)

Unit Key Vocabulary: Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-Faire • Cesspit • Back-to-back housing • Public Health Act 1848 • Public Health Act 1875 • Broad Street Pump • The Great Stink • Sewage System • Edwin Chadwick • John Snow • Joseph Bazalgette • Industrial Revolution

Medieval England: 1066–1485

Year 7 | How was power won, maintained, and lost in Medieval England?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

MONARCHY, LAW & STATE POWER

Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

FEUDAL ECONOMY & MILITARY TECH

Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

CATHOLIC HEGEMONY & IDEOLOGY

Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

POPULAR & BARONIAL RESISTANCE

Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 1066 & The Battle of Hastings: Why did William win? CAUSATION (1066 SUCCESSION CRISIS)	- Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which was strongest. - Explain how military tactics, physical exhaustion, and battlefield leadership decided the Battle of Hastings. - Evaluate whether William won through tactical superiority or whether King Harold lost due to exhaustion and bad luck. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: If bloodline succession was not legally binding in 1066, what gave a medieval claimant true legitimacy: royal election, papal blessing, or military force?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: King Edward the Confessor on his Deathbed (c. 1070s); Source B: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle (Manuscript C, 1066) on the Battle of Stamford Bridge DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether William won through tactical superiority or whether King Harold lost due to exhaustion and bad luck. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 2 Castles, Terror & Domesday: How did William control England? HISTORICAL EVIDENCE (BAYEUX TAPESTRY)	- Explain how William used Motte and Bailey castles as instruments of military domination. - Describe the Harrying of the North and evaluate its devastation as medieval scorched-earth warfare. - Assess the role of the 1086 Domesday Book in establishing royal surveillance and fiscal control. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why were early Norman castles made of wood and earth rather than stone, and how did this speed William's conquest?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Normans Constructing a Motte and Bailey Castle at Hastings (c. 1070s); Source B: Orderic Vitalis, Ecclesiastical History (c. 1120s) on the Harrying of the North DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Describe the Harrying of the North and evaluate its devastation as medieval scorched-earth warfare. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 3 Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket? SIGNIFICANCE & STATE CONTROL (DOMESDAY BOOK)	- Explain the legal conflict over the Constitutions of Clarendon and 'criminous clerks'. - Describe the escalation from exile to the excommunications of 1170. - Evaluate whether Becket's murder resulted from institutional conflict or personal pride. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the privilege of "Benefit of Clergy" threaten to divide England into two separate legal systems?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Depiction of King Henry II and Chancellor Thomas Becket (12th-Century Manuscript); Source B: Clause 3 of the Constitutions of Clarendon (1164) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether Becket's murder resulted from institutional conflict or personal pride. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 Magna Carta (1215): Liberty or Barons' Power Grab? CHANGE & CONTINUITY (FEUDAL STRUCTURE)	- Explain how King John's military failures and arbitrary taxation drove the barons to rebel. - Analyse the key clauses of Magna Carta, particularly Clause 39 and Clause 40. - Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a selfish baronial pact or a charter of liberty. Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the loss of Normandy in 1204 make King John far more dangerous and extortionate to his English subjects?	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Roger of Wendover, Flowers of History (c. 1220s) on King John's Extortions; Source B: Clauses 12, 39, and 61 of Magna Carta (15 June 1215) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a selfish baronial pact or a charter of liberty. CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 Doom Paintings & Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?  INTERPRETATIONS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW (MAGNA CARTA)	- Describe the social structure of the Three Estates and open-field farming. - Explain manorial obligations, Church tithes, and local Hampshire episcopal estates. - Evaluate how Doom paintings and fear of Hell policed peasant behavior. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did medieval society believe that strict inequality between the Three Estates was God's divine will?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Luttrell Psalter: Peasants Reaping Wheat Under the Reeve's Direction (c. 1330); Source B: The Pipe Rolls of the Bishopric of Winchester for the Manor of Bishop's Waltham (c. 1210)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how Doom paintings and fear of Hell policed peasant behavior.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 6 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE (THE BLACK DEATH)	- Describe the arrival and biological horror of the plague in 1348. - Explain how acute labour shortages dismantled feudal ties. - Evaluate whether the Black Death triggered a "Golden Age" for surviving peasants. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why were medieval medical explanations (miasma, alignment of planets, God's wrath) powerless to halt the epidemic?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Henry Knighton, Chronicle of Leicester Abbey on the Black Death (1348–1349); Source B: Bishop Ralph of Shrewsbury's Emergency Letter to the Diocese of Bath and Wells (January 1349)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether the Black Death triggered a "Golden Age" for surviving peasants.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 7 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Explain the socio-economic causes and the catalyst of the 1381 Poll Tax. - Describe the march on London, the Tower storming, and Smithfield. - Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt achieved anything in the long term. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why was a flat-rate Poll Tax of 12 pence considered far more intolerable by peasants than traditional feudal tithes?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Jean Froissart on the Preaching of Radical Priest John Ball (c. 1380s); Source B: The Anonimale Chronicle: The Execution of Archbishop Sudbury (1381)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt achieved anything in the long term.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 8 The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485): Dynastic Bloodbath  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Explain the structural causes of the Wars of the Roses (Henry VI & Bastard Feudalism). - Analyse the bloody escalation of the war from Towton to the Princes in the Tower. - Evaluate the significance of Bosworth Field (1485) in ending the medieval era. <i>Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the medieval monarchy require a ruthless, warrior king, and why was a gentle, saintly king like Henry VI a national disaster?</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Crowland Chronicle on the Factionalism and Weakness of Henry VI (c. 1450s); Source B: The Chronicle of the Brut on the Slaughter at the Battle of Towton (1461)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the significance of Bosworth Field (1485) in ending the medieval era.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron • Peasantry • Tithe • Feudalism • Serf • Strip farming • Black Death • Change • Labour shortage • Statute of Labourers • Social order • Revolt • Poll tax • Wat Tyler • Villeinage • Dynasty • Usurper • Synthesis • Evidence • Judgement		